

Act Now!

Q My Windows XP installation got corrupted, and I had to clean-format my hard drive and install Windows afresh. Now, when I try to activate Windows, the activation window is blank and I don't know how to proceed. Please help—I only have a few days left to activate Windows!

Praful Mehta

A There are three known reasons for this problem: either your Registry has been damaged or modified, your files have gotten damaged during the Windows installation, or some files may be missing. Follow these steps to rectify your problem:

1. Restart your computer, press [F8], select the Windows Advanced Options menu, and choose "Enable VGA Mode". Try and complete the WPA process now. If you cannot start the WPA Wizard, continue to the next step.

2. Open the Device Manager by running "devmgmt.msc". Right-click on your video adapter, and click Disable. Restart the computer, which will now start using the Standard VGA video driver. Try and start the WPA Wizard; if it doesn't, continue to the next step.

3. Open the Registry Editor and locate the following key and its associated values:

Key: HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\.htm

Values: "PerceivedType"="text"; (Default) = "MozillaHTML"; "Content Type"="image/x-xbitmap"

If the key does not exist, go to the next step. If the key does exist, modify the values as so:

"PerceivedType"="text"

(Default) = "htmlfile"

"Content Type"="text/html"

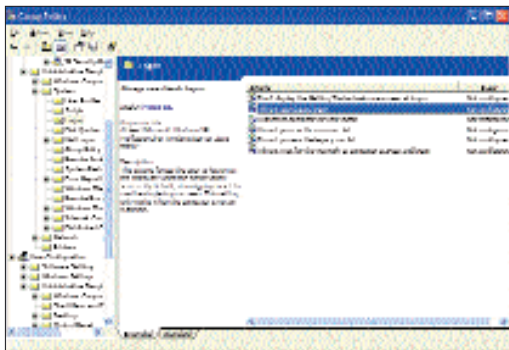
Restart your computer, and try and start the WPA Wizard. If you can't, continue to the next step.

4. Reinstall the Oobe.inf file. To do this, run "inf", and in the Inf folder that opens, right-click oobe.inf and click Install. Insert the XP CD when prompted. Manually register the Jscript.dll and Vbscript.dll files. To do this, at a command prompt, type in the following, pressing [Enter] after each command:

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regsvr32 jscript.dll
regsvr32 vbscript.dll
```

Try launching the Wizard now; it should run correctly.

A Open the Group Policy Editor by running "GPEDIT.MSC". Now go to **Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Logon**. Double-click on "Always use classic logon" in the right pane. Select the "Disabled" radio button and click OK. Close the Group Policy Editor.



Use the Group Policy Editor to restore the Welcome Screen

command prompt, type in the following (where "X" is your CD-ROM drive letter) and allow the new files to overwrite the old ones.

COPY X:\i386\NTLDR C:

COPY X:\i386\NTDETECT.COM C:

Like we said, it could even be a damaged Boot Sector. In that case, what you need to do is, at the command prompt, type in "FIXBOOT" and press [Enter]. Then answer "Y". Remember that this won't cause any harm even if the boot sector is not damaged.

Deep Sleep

Q I have Windows XP Pro installed with 1 GB of RAM. I recently noticed a 1 GB file called hiberfil.sys in the root of the C: drive. What is this file, and is it safe to delete it? It occupies so much disk space!

Pragat Mukesh

The Boot Bane

Q I have two operating systems—my C: drive has Windows 98 SE, and the F: drive has XP SP2. Recently, some files in Windows 98 got corrupted, and I had to re-install it. I did so (back on the C: drive) successfully, but when I started my system, I found that the boot loader was missing. I don't want to reinstall XP. How can I bring the boot loader back?

Vipin Varghese

A If XP won't start, it may be due to a damaged boot sector, or missing (or corrupt) ntldr and/or ntdelect.com files.

To replace the damaged ntldr and ntdelect.com, you can copy fresh files from the XP CD using the COPY command. Boot with the XP CD and enter the Recovery Console. At the



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